

Running Royals

Cross Country · Family Schedule · Fall 2026

Practices are Wednesday, Friday and Sunday. First practice is Sunday, August 30.

Every practice: warm-up laps and drills, the workout, then cool down and stretch. Plan on about an hour.

MEET 1

Sat, Sep 19

Paul VI High School

MEET 2

Sat, Oct 17

Lake Fairfax Park

MEET 3

Sat, Nov 7

Fort Hunt Park

August 2026

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
						1
2	3	4	5	6	7	8
9	10	11	12	13	14	15
16	17	18	19	20	21	22
23	24	25	26	27	28	29
30 TRACK Getting started	31					

September 2026

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
		1	2 HILLS	3	4 DISTANCE	5
6 TRACK Ladder	7	8	9 TEMPO	10	11 DISTANCE	12
13 TRACK Race pace	14	15	16 HILLS	17	18 SHAKEOUT	19 MEET 1 Paul VI HS
20 RECOVERY Recovery + relay	21	22	23 TEMPO	24	25 DISTANCE	26
27 TRACK Ladder	28	29	30 HILLS			

October 2026

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
				1	2 DISTANCE	3
4 TRACK Fartlek	5	6	7 TEMPO	8	9 DISTANCE	10
11 TRACK Race pace	12	13	14 HILLS	15	16 SHAKEOUT	17 MEET 2 Lake Fairfax
18 TRACK Full ladder	19	20	21 TEMPO	22	23 DISTANCE	24
25 TRACK Cut-downs	26	27	28 HILLS	29	30 DISTANCE	31

November 2026

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1 TRACK Sharpen	2	3	4 HILLS	5	6 SHAKEOUT	7 MEET 3 Fort Hunt Park
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30					

WORKOUT TYPE

■ Hills
 ■ Tempo
 ■ Track
 ■ Distance
 ■ Shakeout
 ■ Recovery
 ■ Meet

The week, every week

WEDNESDAY Hills or tempo. The hardest day of the week.

FRIDAY Distance run. On meet weeks this becomes a short, easy shakeout so legs are fresh for Saturday.

SUNDAY Track. Ladders that build up to the longest rep and come back down, plus race-pace and relay days.

Running Royals

What your runner will be doing

3RD AND 4TH GRADE

Jackrabbits

Short, fast bursts with long rests. Track reps up to 600m, Friday runs of 1 to 1.5 miles, and 3 to 6 hill repeats.

5TH AND 6TH GRADE

Cheetahs

Learning to hold a pace and close hard. Track ladders up to 800m, Friday runs of 1.5 to 2 miles, and 4 to 8 hill repeats.

7TH AND 8TH GRADE

Falcons

Real mileage and real tempo work. Full ladders peaking at 800m, Friday runs of 2 to 3 miles, and 5 to 10 hill repeats.

What to bring

Shoes Running shoes with laces tied. No cleats, sandals or slip-ons. Meet courses are grass and dirt, so old shoes are fine.

Water A full labeled water bottle at every practice. Runners drink at the end of the warm-up and again after stretching.

Weather Practice runs in light rain. We cancel for lightning or unsafe heat, and you'll hear from the coaches before start time.

Name Please label bottles, jackets and bags. The lost-and-found pile grows fast in October.

On meet days

Arrive early Plan to be on site at least 45 minutes before your runner's race so they can walk the course with their group.

Bring layers November at Fort Hunt is cold. Sweatpants and a jacket to pull on right after finishing make a real difference.

Eat light A normal breakfast about two hours before the race, then water. Heavy food right before a race causes side stitches.

Cheer anywhere Courses loop, so you can usually see runners two or three times. The far side of the course is the loneliest and best place to stand.

Good to know

Missing practice It happens, just let a coach know. Runners who miss a Sunday track session should treat the next one as a fresh start, not double up.

Soreness Normal in the first two weeks. Pain in a joint, a limp, or soreness that lasts more than a few days is worth a call to your pediatrician.

Groups can move Runners are grouped by grade, but we move runners up or down based on what they can finish comfortably. Ask a coach any time.

The goal Every runner should finish practice wanting one more rep, not flattened. Improvement over the season matters more than any single race.